Q+A

GETTING INTO CHARACTER

***Pankaj Tripathi** is back as Madhav Mishra in the fourth season of* Criminal Justice *and is all set to reunite with Anurag Basu in* Metro...In Dino

Q. You've played Madhav Mishra in *Criminal Justice* across four seasons now. How do you keep finding new layers to a character you've inhabited for so long?

Every season is a new case and a new situation. This also means new aspects of Madhav Mishra's past experiences get added to the plot-line, which allows me to play him with a fresh perspective.

Q. Having worked with Anurag Basu in *Ludo* and now *Metro...In Dino*, how would you describe the creative rhythm you share?

If I had one word to describe it, it would be brilliant. As an actor, I don't like to go to a set too prepared. He also doesn't demand it. Instead, he wants us to find the character on the spot. I enjoy the unknown, so I have enjoyed collaborating with him.

Q. You recently shot a film in Bihar—your home state—for the first time in your career. Was that experience different from how you expected it would be?

I didn't expect it to be as emotional as it ended up being. I began my journey as a performer on the dusty streets of a small village in Bihar, never imagining that one day I would return to these very lanes with a film crew.

Q. Has there been a role in the past few years that truly challenged or transformed you as an actor?

That would be my character from *OMG 2* because it required me to talk about sex education and make it look graceful. I feel the role helped me evolve as a human being.

—With Poulomi Das



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